

married. As with most couples experiencing financial problems, they simply lacked the desire to seek the Lord together.

Allen contacted the bank that issued the MasterCard, and it agreed to accept a minimum payment on the account for three months while it worked with Art Hill to work out a permanent resolution. Art then contacted Gary Barnes at the bank and arranged for the bank to accept a three-month moratorium (no payments) on the second mortgage, provided that the first mortgage was brought up to date during the following month.

The plan was simple and direct. Both Allen and Sherry realized that they were in over their heads financially and that they had to reduce their expenses. There were only two areas that could be cut substantially: housing and autos. The house and one car had to be sold if they were ever to balance their budget. Both decisions were difficult for them to accept until all the figures were on the table and visible. Then the facts dictated the decisions. They could stay in their home until it was repossessed or sell it voluntarily. They could drive one new car or lose them both. These were tough facts but easy decisions.

They had only one asset that could be converted into immediate cash to pay the bank: a cash value insurance policy that Allen had owned for several years. It had nearly \$3,000 in cash value, and they used it to bring the first mortgage to a current status.

They put the house up for sale, and when it finally sold, they recovered enough from the sale to pay off the credit cards and much of the second mortgage. The bank willingly agreed to carry a note for the remaining amount, which was paid off within the next year.

Allen and Sherry rented a nice apartment and worked hard to get their finances under control. They developed a realistic budget and began to give to their church each month. Eventually they used their own experiences to help with classes in their church, teaching on biblical principles of handling money.

Allen became a partner in the law firm and ten years later was made the senior partner in the real estate department. He instituted